

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Saved by a shark?



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about nature and the animal world.
- I can talk about local and international news.
- I can talk about hypothetical situations.

Ask your partner:

- How do you feel about sharks? Is there anything that would change your mind about them?
- Have you heard any stories in the news about sharks? What happened?





Let's Explore!

Let's read an article about a shark saving two people. Do you believe it?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

A father and son who were stuck on a raft in the ocean for four days without food or water said their lives were saved by a shark.

Roy Thomas and his eight-year-old son, Jeremy, were alone in the ocean after their sailboat sank last Sunday. They had a tiny rubber raft to keep them afloat, but no food or water. After four days they were so weak that they could hardly move. Suddenly, they were woken by a shark.

Thomas told how the shark swam up to the raft and tried to attack them. "It was not the first shark we saw," Thomas told reporters, "but this one really wanted to get us."

The shark was driven away by Thomas stabbing it on the back with a pocket knife. When his dad finished fighting off the shark, Jeremy saw a boat passing by. The father and son waved for help until the captain of the boat noticed them. The two were picked up and brought to safety. "My Dad was a real hero," Jeremy said proudly, "just like in the movies."

"Nevertheless," Thomas says, "If I saw a shark again, I would remember this story and feel less hatred toward sharks."





Let's Practice!

What's it like at sea*?

*When you are "at sea", you are out in the ocean.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Choose the correct answer.

- 1) For emergencies, a small _____ is included with sail boats.
 - a. rude raft
 - b. rubber raft
 - c. rafting
- 2) You can _____ a shark by punching it in the nose, or stabbing it with a pocket _____.
 - a. drive away, knife
 - b. drive in, knife
 - c. drive, knife
- 3) You start to feel very _____ after many days _____ on a raft.
 - a. week, afloat
 - b. weak, a float



Let's Practice!

What would happen if ... ?

Instructions: Match the sentences in Column A and Column B.

COLUMN A

COLUMN B

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. If you went out to sea in a boat, | a. I would be prepared. |
| 2. If I saw a shark again, | b. you would take a rubber raft with you. |
| 3. I would be very scared | c. I would become very weak. |
| 4. If I carried the pocket knife for emergencies, | d. if I were woken up by a shark. |
| 5. If I stayed afloat at sea for days, | e. I would remember this story and feel less hatred toward sharks. |





Extension Activity

Let's imagine!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On 8 different pieces of paper, write down 8 verbs.
- Your partner writes down 8 nouns.
- Mix the papers together.
- Choose one verb and one noun and use those to talk about an imaginary situation.
- Be as creative as you can.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about imaginary situations.

☐ ☐

I get creative with English verbs and nouns.

☐ ☐

My partner and I discuss hypothetical situations.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **rubber raft** (noun): a small boat made of rubber for emergencies
e.g. They were stuck on a rubber raft for four days.
- **afloat** (adjective): floating in water; not sinking
e.g. They had a tiny rubber raft to keep them afloat.
- **weak** (adjective): not strong
e.g. After four days they were very weak.
- **to drive away** (expression): to force to go away
e.g. Thomas drove the shark away.
- **pocket knife** (noun): a small folding knife
e.g. Thomas stabbed the shark with a pocket knife.
- **hatred** (noun): the feeling of strong emotional dislike toward someone
e.g. I feel less hatred toward sharks.





Learning Points

The Passive Voice

You often read or hear the passive voice being used in news reports. This is because the passive voice focuses the attention on the receiver of the action, rather than the doer of the action. In a news context, *what* happened is more important than who acted.

Here is an active sentence:

(Subject + Verb + Object) *A shark saved a father and son.*
"The shark" is the focus of the sentence.

Here is a passive sentence:

(Passive subject + To Be + Past Participle) *A father and son were saved (by a shark).*
"The father and son" are the focus of the sentence.

It is often optional to include the agent, or doer, of the action in a passive sentence. This is because it is often unimportant or already understood within the context of the story.

Examples:

- *Their lives were saved (by a shark).*
- *They were woken up (by a shark).*





Learning Points

The Second Conditional - Talking About Hypothetical Situations

When you want to talk about an imaginary or hypothetical situation, you use the second conditional.

For example:

If I saw a shark, I would freak out!

Are you going to see a shark? No.

Is it possible to suddenly see a shark? Not really.

What would happen if you saw a shark? You would freak out.

The second conditional contains both a condition clause (with if) and a result clause.

If	Conditional	Result
	Simple Past	would + base verb
<i>If</i>	<i>I went swimming,</i>	<i>I would check for sharks first.</i>
<i>If</i>	<i>it suddenly started raining,</i>	<i>I would be stranded without an umbrella.</i>
<i>If</i>	<i>I were you,</i>	<i>I would look into the different options for a cruise.</i>

Remember to use a comma (,) after the IF clause.

In conversation, it is common to use contractions. (I would = I'd.)

Examples:

- *If I saw a shark again, I would remember this story and feel less hatred toward sharks.*
- *I wouldn't go swimming if I knew there were sharks in the water.*

